

1960

JANUARY 26

The South Vietnamese 32nd regiment is defeated in an attack by Viet Cong guerrillas at the village of Trang Sup, northeast of Saigon.

AUGUST 9

In Laos, Captain Kong Le seizes power in a military coup and denounces American influence in his country. Laos increasingly becomes a focus of Cold War tension between the United States and the Soviet Union.

NOVEMBER 8

Democrat candidate John F. Kennedy, with Lyndon B. Johnson as his running mate, narrowly defeats Republican Richard Nixon in the US presidential election.

NOVEMBER 11–12

President Diem survives an attempted military coup led by officers of the South Vietnamese Airborne Division.

DECEMBER 12

With the backing of the North Vietnamese politburo, the National Liberation Front (NLF) is formed as the political wing of the antigovernment insurgency in South Vietnam.

DECEMBER 31

By the year's end, there are about 900 American military personnel in South Vietnam. Five American soldiers have been killed there during the course of the year.